

Eat Clean Without Stress — Simple Habits for Everyday Life

Transcript (B1)

Hi everyone. Welcome back to the five minute English practice. I'm Jessica and I'm really happy you decided to spend some time with us today. Today we're talking about a topic that comes up a lot when people start caring more about their health, their energy, and the way they feel every day. And that topic is eating clean. Some people feel very excited when they hear this phrase because they think it means a fresh start and better habits, while other people feel stressed right away because they imagine strict rules, boring food, and a lifestyle that feels hard to maintain. So today, instead of giving advice or telling you what you should or shouldn't eat, we're simply going to talk honestly about food habits, mistakes, and what eating clean actually looks like in real life, not in a perfect online world. I'm not doing this episode alone. I'm here with Lisa, who has tried eating clean in a very realistic way while working, feeling tired, craving snacks, and still wanting to enjoy food. Hi, Lisa. How are you today? Hi, Jessica. Hi, everyone. I'm doing really well, thank you. And I love this topic because eating clean didn't just change what I eat. It really changed how I think about food and how I listen to my body. I really like that you said that because eating clean is not just about meals. It's also about awareness and daily choices. Let's go back to the beginning for a moment. Lisa, when you first heard the phrase eat clean, what did you imagine? To be honest, I imagined a very boring life. I thought eating clean meant eating plain food with no flavor, no sugar, no fun, and no comfort. And I honestly thought I would feel hungry, tired, and unhappy all the time if I tried to eat that way. That image is very common, and I had the exact same thought. I believed eating clean meant giving up food that makes life enjoyable.

>> Yes. And because of that, I avoided it for a long time. Even though deep down I knew my eating habits were not making me feel very good.

>> So what made you finally decide to try eating clean?

>> I started noticing that after most meals I felt heavy, sleepy, and unfocused, especially in the afternoon. And I realized that even though I was eating enough, my body didn't feel satisfied or energized. That moment is very important because many people start eating clean not because they want to change how they look but because they want to change how they feel.

>> Exactly. I didn't want a perfect diet. I just wanted to feel better during the day.

>> So now after some time, how would you describe eating clean in your own words? For me, eating clean means choosing simple food that feels natural, cooking more meals at home, and eating things that make me feel good after I finish eating instead of feeling uncomfortable or tired. I love that description because it feels very realistic and very kind. For me, eating clean means I try to slow down and think about what my body actually needs instead of eating something just because it's fast or easy.

>> Yes. And that mindset already changes a lot.

>> Let's talk about breakfast because the way we start the day often affects everything else. What does a typical clean breakfast look like for you? Most mornings I eat oatmeal and I like to take my time preparing it, adding fruit, nuts, maybe a little honey or peanut butter because it feels warm, filling and comforting, especially on busy mornings. I really like oatmeal for the same reason. It feels gentle on the body, but it also gives enough energy to start the day without feeling heavy. On other days, I

choose eggs, usually scrambled eggs with avocado or eggs with toast because it keeps me full and focused for a long time. Yes, eggs made a big difference for me. Before, I often skipped breakfast or just had coffee and I didn't realize how much that affected my mood and energy later in the day. That's such an important point. When you eat real breakfast, your whole day feels more balanced.

>> Exactly. I feel more calm and less rushed when I start the day with proper food. Now, let's move to lunch because lunch is often eaten in a hurry. What do you usually eat for lunch when you try to eat clean? I try to keep lunch very simple and satisfying, usually with grilled chicken or fish, a lot of vegetables and something warm and comforting like roasted potatoes or a big salad with olive oil. That sounds very similar to what I eat. I often prepare chicken or fish in advance and then add vegetables and potatoes because it's easy, filling, and doesn't make me feel sleepy afterward. Yes, that sleepy feeling after lunch disappeared when I stopped eating heavy and processed food.

>> That's something many people notice. Clean food doesn't make you feel slow.

>> Exactly. And I also learned that clean food doesn't need to be fancy. It just needs to be simple and cooked with care.

>> Now, let's talk about snacks because snacks are where many people feel they fail. Lisa, do you snack during the day?

>> Yes, I do. Especially in the afternoon when my energy drops and I start craving something sweet or crunchy.

>> That time of day is very dangerous.

>> Very dangerous. In the past, I ate cookies or chips without thinking. When I started eating clean, I tried to stop snacking completely, but that only made me feel frustrated.

>> That never works for long. Exactly. So now I still snack, but I choose things that actually help my body, like a fruit with peanut butter, yogurt, nuts, or boiled eggs. That's exactly what I do, too. I don't try to be perfect. I just try to make better choices most of the time.

>> And that made eating clean feel much more realistic. Let's talk about dinner because many people think dinner should be very small or boring when eating clean. What do you think?

>> I don't agree with that at all. Dinner is the time when I want to relax, slow down, and enjoy my food. So, I still eat a proper meal. Same here. I often eat baked fish with vegetables or chicken with roasted potatoes and salad because it feels complete and satisfying.

>> Yes. And sometimes I eat pasta, but I keep it simple with olive oil, garlic, vegetables, and maybe some cheese instead of heavy sauce. That's such a good example. Eating clean doesn't mean cutting food out. It means choosing a simpler version.

>> Exactly. Now, let's talk about processed food. How do you see it? Now processed food is something I still eat sometimes but it's no longer part of my daily routine and I feel the difference very clearly. That difference is huge. It becomes a choice not a habit.

>> Yes. And when it's a choice you don't feel guilty.

>> Let's talk about eating out because food is social. How do you handle eating clean when you eat out?

>> I stop stressing about it when I eat out. I choose something simple if I can and if I can't I enjoy the meal and move on.

>> No guilt, no punishment the next day.

>> Exactly. Guilt only makes things worse.

>> Do you prepare food in advance?

>> Yes, but only basics. I prepare protein, vegetables, and potatoes. So, I don't need to think too much during the week. That already saves a lot of time and energy and it makes eating clean much easier. After eating this way for some time, what changes did you notice? I had more energy, better digestion, clearer skin, and I felt more connected to my body and my needs.

>> That's beautiful.

>> And mentally, I felt proud because I was taking care of myself.

>> That feeling matters more than numbers on a scale.

>> Absolutely. Before we end, what advice would you give to someone who wants to start eating clean?

>> Start small, be patient, and don't try to be perfect. Focus on how food makes you feel, not just what it looks like. That's perfect advice. Thank you so much, Lisa, for this honest and calm conversation. And thank you to everyone listening. Remember, eating clean is about simple food, balance, and listening to your body. Take care and I'll see you next time.